

Plants under plastic

These corn plants are keeping warm and moist as they grow under biodegradable plastic at a farm in Wales, UK. Over time, the plastic breaks down naturally and its harmless remains are consumed by microbes in the soil.



Compostable bottles

A compostable plastic made from sugarcane has been used to create these plastic bottles in a factory in France. They will decompose into water, carbon dioxide, and humus, an ingredient of soil.



Edible cups

Single-use plastic cups are a big source of plastic waste. One solution is to produce them from materials that can be eaten. In 2016, the Indonesian brand Evoware used seaweed to produce colorful edible cups, called Ello Jello.



Jute bags

Jute is a plant-based fiber that can be woven into materials such as burlap and hessian. Unlike cotton, jute can be grown with little more than rainwater, requiring almost no fertilizer or pesticides, making it a more environmentally friendly option.